FIELD BEHAVIOURAL REPORT

Consumer Behaviour in One Moment: A Live Field Study

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1.Field Context and Objectives

Consumer behaviour is the study of how people make decisions while buying products and services in real-life situations. These decisions are not always logical or planned. Many psychological, social, emotional, and environmental factors influence the final decision of a consumer. Sometimes, a consumer plans to buy something but ends up buying something else due to external influence. At other times, a consumer may not plan anything but still ends up purchasing something.

This project focuses on understanding such real-life behaviour at the point of decision-making. The study was conducted in two different environments:

- **Shopping Mall (Grand Venice Mall)**
- **High Street Market (Alpha 2)**

These two locations were chosen because they represent two very different types of consumption environments. A shopping mall is a controlled, organized, and experience-based environment where brands, lighting, music, and offers are carefully designed to influence consumer behaviour. On the other hand, a high street market is more open, unstructured, and practical, where consumers focus more on price, availability, and immediate need.

➢ Objectives of the Study

The main objectives of this study are:

- To understand how consumers make decisions at the exact moment of purchase
- To identify whether decisions are planned or impulsive
- To analyze internal factors such as motivation, perception, memory, and attitude
- To study external influences such as friends, family, and recommendations
- To understand the role of digital platforms like Google search and ratings
- To analyze emotional triggers like discounts, ambience, and trust
- To compare behaviour between mall and high street environments

This study helps in understanding how different environments shape consumer thinking and behaviour.

2. Methodology

This research is based on a field-based experiential study, where real consumers were observed and interviewed at the point of purchase.

➢ Data Collection Method

- Short interviews of 3–5 minutes were conducted
- Open-ended questions were used to get detailed and natural responses
- Observations were also made about consumer behaviour and surroundings

➢ Sample Size

- Total respondents: 4
- Shopping Mall: 2 respondents
- High Street: 2 respondents

➢ Locations

- Grand Venice Mall
- Alpha 2 High Street

➢ Procedure

Consumers were randomly approached during their purchase process. They were asked simple questions about their decision-making. Their answers were recorded and later analyzed using behavioural science concepts.

➢ Limitations

- Small sample size
- Short duration of interviews
- Responses depend on individual perception

Even though the sample size is limited, the study provides meaningful real-world insights.

3. Behavioural Insights and Patterns

➢ Decision Type (Planned vs Impulse)

Decision type refers to whether a consumer planned the purchase in advance or made the decision on the spot.

❖ Mall Behaviour

In the mall environment, both planned and impulse decisions were clearly observed.

- One consumer entered the mall without a clear plan and decided what to buy after exploring the stores. This is an example of impulse buying, where the decision is influenced by the environment.
- Another consumer came with a clear intention to buy a specific product. This is an example of a planned decision, where the consumer already knows what they want.

This shows that malls are designed in such a way that even planned buyers can become impulsive. The presence of attractive displays, lighting, music, and offers creates a strong influence on the consumer's mind.

Malls create a psychologically stimulating environment where impulse buying is encouraged. Even consumers who enter with a plan may change their decision due to external stimuli.

❖ High Street Behaviour

In the high street environment, decision-making was more situational and practical.

- One consumer came to the area just to meet a friend and had no intention to purchase anything. However, they ended up buying something based on need.
- Another consumer did not have a fixed plan but made a decision after observing price and crowd.

High street decisions are mostly need-based and depend on immediate situations. There is less emotional pressure compared to malls.

➢ Evoked Set Formation

Evoked set refers to the group of brands or options that a consumer considers before making a purchase.

❖ Mall

In malls, consumers already have a fixed set of brands in mind.

- Brands like H&M, Mango, and Westside are commonly considered
- Past experience plays a major role in decision-making

Consumers rely on their memory and previous satisfaction with brands. This reduces the need for comparison.

Mall consumers show strong brand recall and loyalty. Their evoked set is limited but strong.

❖ High Street

In high street markets, there is no fixed brand preference.

- Consumers explore multiple shops
- They compare prices, quality, and ratings
- Decisions are flexible and change based on available options

High street consumers have a dynamic evoked set. Their decision depends on comparison and availability rather than brand loyalty.

3.3 Internal Determinants

Internal determinants are psychological factors that influence consumer decisions.

1. Motivation

Motivation is the reason why a consumer wants to buy something.

- In malls, motivation is based on quality, brand value, and lifestyle

- In high street, motivation is based on need and affordability

Mall consumers are driven by aspiration and image, while high street consumers are driven by necessity and budget.

2. Perception

Perception is how consumers see and understand a product.

- In malls, consumers perceive branded products as high quality
- In high street, perception depends on external signals like crowd, hygiene, and price

In the absence of strong brands, high street consumers use indirect signals to judge quality.

3. Learning and Memory

Learning and memory refer to past experiences that influence current decisions.

- Mall consumers strongly depend on past experience
- Example: "H&M is my comfort brand"
- High street consumers rely less on memory and more on exploration

Habit-based buying is common in malls but not in high street markets.

4. Attitude

Attitude is the overall mindset of the consumer.

- Mall consumers have a positive attitude towards brands
- High street consumers have a practical and value-based attitude

Mall buying is emotional, while high street buying is rational.

3.4 External Determinants

External determinants are outside factors that influence consumer behaviour.

1. Social Influence

- Mall consumers mostly make independent decisions
- High street consumers are sometimes influenced by recommendations

Social influence is stronger in high street because trust is built through people.

2. Digital Influence

- Mall consumers rely less on digital tools
- High street consumers actively use Google search and ratings

Digital platforms play a major role in guiding decisions in unorganized markets.

3.5 Emotional and Environmental Factors

❖ Mall

- Offers and discounts create excitement and urgency
- Ambience, lighting, and music influence emotions
- Consumers feel comfortable and confident

Malls are designed to trigger emotions and increase spending.

❖ High Street

- Emotions are linked to price and trust
- Consumers feel satisfied when they get value for money
- Trust is not always guaranteed

High street provides functional satisfaction but not emotional comfort.

4. Integration of Internal and External Influences

Consumer decisions are always a combination of internal and external factors.

➢ Mall Example

- Internal: Brand loyalty, past experience
- External: Offers, ambience

Emotional and brand-driven decision

➢ High Street Example

- Internal: Need, price sensitivity
- External: Recommendations, ratings

Rational and value-based decision

5. Emotional, Digital, and Ethical Analysis

➢ Emotional Analysis

Mall environments create excitement, urgency, and happiness. High street environments create satisfaction through affordability.

➢ Digital Analysis

High street consumers depend more on digital tools, while mall consumers depend on physical experience.

➢ Ethical Analysis

- No personal data was collected
- Participation was voluntary
- No manipulation was done

6. Managerial Implications

➢ For Mall Businesses

- Focus on emotional marketing
- Use lighting, music, and display effectively
- Offer discounts to trigger impulse buying

➢ For High Street Vendors

- Improve cleanliness and trust
- Use digital platforms for visibility
- Offer competitive pricing

7. Behavioural Evidence Appendix

➢ Observation Notes

- Mall: Structured, branded, emotional
- High street: Open, competitive, practical

➢ Interview Excerpts

- "I decided after coming here" → Impulse buying
- "H&M is my comfort brand" → Brand loyalty
- "Depends on budget" → Price sensitivity
- "Checked ratings first" → Digital influence

8. Managerial Action Note

➢ Key Behavioural Insights

- Mall consumers are emotional and brand-focused
- High street consumers are rational and price-sensitive
- Digital influence is growing in high street
- Brand loyalty is strong in malls

➢ Recommendations

❖ Mall

- Create emotional experience
- Use attractive displays

❖ High Street

- Build trust
- Improve digital presence

❖ Ethical Concerns

- Avoid fake offers
- Maintain transparency

9. Conclusion

This study clearly shows that consumer behaviour is highly dependent on the environment in which the purchase takes place. The same consumer can behave very differently in a mall and in a high street market.

In shopping malls, consumer behaviour is strongly influenced by emotions, brand image, and overall experience. The environment is designed in such a way that it attracts consumers and encourages them to spend more. Factors like lighting, music, store layout, and discounts create a psychological impact that often leads to impulse buying. Consumers also rely heavily on brands they trust, which reduces their effort in decision-making.

On the other hand, in high street markets, consumer behaviour is more practical and rational. Decisions are mainly based on price, need, and available options. Consumers actively compare different shops and often use digital tools like Google search and ratings to make better decisions. Emotional influence is lower, and trust is built slowly through experience and recommendations.

Another important finding is that digital influence is becoming very important in high street environments. Consumers are using online information to reduce risk and make better choices. At the same time, malls still depend more on physical experience rather than digital influence.

This study also highlights that internal factors like motivation, perception, and memory work together with external factors like social influence and environment to shape consumer behaviour. No decision is made based on a single factor. It is always a combination of multiple influences.

Overall, this study helps in understanding the difference between emotional and rational buying behaviour. It shows that businesses must design their strategies according to the environment. Malls should focus on experience and emotional connection, while high street vendors should focus on price, trust, and digital presence.Understanding these behavioural patterns is very important for marketers. It helps them create better strategies, improve customer satisfaction, and increase sales.